

Chapter 9

Worksheet

Instructions:

Please complete all activities in this worksheet. Write your answers in the spaces provided or on separate sheets if needed.

Chapter 9: Public Speaking and Presentation Skills Worksheet

Purpose: This worksheet is designed to help students apply the concepts of public speaking and presentation skills from Chapter 9 through practical exercises and reflection. It covers overcoming anxiety, structuring talks, and engaging audiences. Students can complete this individually or in groups as part of class activities or homework.

Section 1: Overcoming Public Speaking Anxiety

Objective: Identify personal fears and practice strategies to build confidence for speaking in front of others.

Activity 1: Anxiety Check-In

Reflect on your feelings about public speaking and try a calming technique.

- What makes you most nervous about speaking in front of a group (e.g., forgetting words, being judged)?
- Rate your anxiety level on a scale of 1-10 (1 = totally calm, 10 = super nervous): _____
- Try this: Take 3 deep breaths (inhale 4 seconds, hold 4, exhale 4). How do you feel after?

Reflection Question: What's one small step you can take this week to feel less nervous (e.g., practicing in front of a friend)?

Section 2: Structuring Engaging Talks

Objective: Learn to organize thoughts into a clear, impactful presentation structure.

Activity 2: Mini-Speech Outline

Create a simple outline for a 3-minute talk on a topic you like (e.g., "Why my favorite hobby is awesome"). Use the Beginning-Middle-End structure.

- **Beginning (Hook + What You'll Cover):**
- **Middle (2-3 Main Points with 1 Example Each):**
 - _____ (Example: _____)
 - _____ (Example: _____)
 - _____ (Example: _____)
- **End (Summary + Strong Closing Line):**

Reflection Question: How does having a structure make preparing a talk easier for you?

Section 3: Engaging Diverse Audiences

Objective: Practice tools like storytelling and visuals to connect with listeners.

Activity 3: Storytelling Starter

Think of a short personal story (e.g., a funny moment or a challenge you faced) that could start a talk on a topic like "Why teamwork matters." Write a 3-4 sentence intro using your story.

- **Story Intro for Talk:**

Reflection Question: How do you think starting with a story can help grab your audience's attention?

Activity 4: Visual Idea Sketch

Pick a simple topic (e.g., "Why sleep is important for teens"). Sketch or describe a quick visual (like a poster or slide) to support your point. Use 1 image idea and 3 words max.

- **Topic:** _____
- **Visual Description/Sketch (e.g., drawing of a sleepy face):**
- **3 Words for Visual (e.g., "Sleep Powers You!"):** _____

Reflection Question: How could this visual make your message more interesting to your classmates?

Overall Reflection

Answer these questions after completing the activities to reflect on your learning from Chapter 9.

- What's one public speaking fear you want to work on, and what strategy will you try?
- How will structuring a talk help you in future situations like a job interview or college presentation?
- What's one engagement tool (storytelling, visuals, etc.) you're excited to use in your next talk, and why?

Bonus Challenge: Practice Run

Try giving your mini-speech from Activity 2 to a friend, family member, or in front of a mirror. Use your story intro from Activity 3 if you can. Write down one thing you did well and one thing to improve.

- **What I Did Well:**
- **What to Improve:**